

CFO-ORC FILE #

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD UNUSUAL RECORD X**Species:** Eurasian Wigeon (*Anas americana*)**Date:** 9 January 2000**Number seen:** one**Sex:** male**Plumage:** Alternate**Locality:** Arkansas River in Pueblo**Elevation:** about 4700'**Nearest town:** Pueblo**County:** Pueblo**Time observed:** 14:00 - 14:10 MST**Duration of observation:** about 10 minutes

Description: Sue Bonfield, Paul Hurtado, and I, after finishing up my gull-ID workshop, went to try to find various Pueblo-area goodies. One of them was the male Eurasian Wigeon that had been present for some time. We found it near the stadium on the Arkansas River.

It was a medium-large dabbling duck foraging on the river, by tipping up. Its head was mostly rust-colored with a wide, pale yellow crown stripe/patch. The back and sides were gray, the folded primaries were dark, the rump was black, and the tail was dark (though I didn't see it very well). The chin and throat were the same rusty color of most of the rest of the head and the chest was a slightly paler pinkish-orange color. The center of the belly was white and the vent was black. There was an obvious white extension from the belly onto the flanks separating the gray sides from the black vent area. The eyes were dark and the bill was mostly bluish with a black tip.

Similar species eliminated: The only similar species are not that similar. American Wigeon is eliminated by head and body coloration, with no suggestion of American Wigeon gene introgression anywhere in the plumage. Green-winged Teal is eliminated by the lack of green on the head, size, and chest and vent coloration.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): No vocalizations heard.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen about 15 Eurasian Wigeons and 1000s of most other dabbling ducks, including the similar species mentioned above.

Light conditions: sun behind me and to my left

Optical equipment used: Leica 32x and Zeiss 7x42

Distance, and how estimated: estimated at about 250m

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Sue Bonfield & Paul Hurtado

Other observers who saw the bird independently: a virtual army of birders

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph

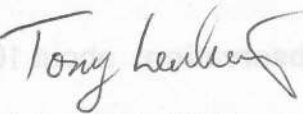
List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:



Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Picadilly Road, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: 28 August 2000 from notes written that night about 7 hours after the sighting